

when the relapse comes, to commence anew when another favourable opportunity offers. As the spring comes in, with its delights and young verdure, and cheering early sun-rays, which draw the notes of the lark and the linnet, the disposition becomes more general to disregard those strict lines of prudence which the bleak winds of autumn and the shorter days of an aging year, mark out so prominently for observation. At a period of the year when spring is merging in early summer, with all its pleasant prospects of pleasure to come, it is quite natural to suppose that a desire should arise to make money, by which everything could be made smooth and delightful during the most enjoyable part of the year. Then again, as the half-year wears on, there are the dividends to look forward to, which is always an inducement to buyers; the great cities are filling with pleasure seekers, the import and export trade with foreign climes is in full activity after the liberation of whole fleets of vessels which have lain frozen up in northern parts during the winter. The young corn is beginning to clothe the naked furrow, and the various fruits of the earth are appearing, which only to read and hear of is to fill the eye with a sense of plenty that half converts a Tory Stock Exchange operator into an ultra-radical speculator. Under fairly favourable circumstances, the course of general business during the first half of the year is more active than during the second six months. The Parliamentary session is in full swing, and large numbers of people congregate in the capital towns of all European states to transact business, no small part of which is the investment of their surplus profits in public securities. When a new year is fairly on its legs, say in March, if war or such like causes do not interfere with the natural course of events, between that month and the end of June, a speculator for the rise should find, on an average, his greatest opportunities. In the London market more especially is it so, on account of the effect produced on the money market by the collection of the revenue, which always keeps the Bank of England's reserve at a comparatively higher figure during the period named, a cir-